

How to use password managers effectively

If you struggle to remember all the different unique passwords for your accounts, technology's coming to your rescue yet again. In case you don't know, password managers securely store all your passwords in one place so you don't have to remember all of them all the time.

Password managers: Benefits vs Limits

Benefits include the ability to generate and store complex passwords, autofill login credentials, and sync across devices. Limitations involve the risk if the master password is compromised. Therefore, it's crucial to create a strong master password and enable additional security features.

How to choose a secure password manager

Choose a password manager with robust encryption, a solid reputation, and features like two-factor authentication (2FA). Look for services that offer cross-platform support and have undergone independent security audits.

Basic setup and best practices

After selecting a password manager, create a strong master password. Enable 2FA for added security. Regularly backup your password database if the option is available, and keep the software updated.

Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) benefits and setup

MFA adds an extra layer of security by requiring additional verification steps. Apart from passwords, think of MFA as providing an additional security shield.

Types of MFA (SMS, Authenticator Apps, Biometrics)

Common MFA methods include:

- **SMS Codes:** A code sent to your mobile device via text message.
- **Authenticator Apps:** Apps like Google Authenticator generate time-based codes.
- **Biometrics:** Fingerprint or facial recognition used for verification.

How to enable MFA on key accounts

To enable MFA, go to the security settings of your account (e.g., email, banking, social media) and follow the prompts to set it up. Choose the MFA method that best suits your needs and device capabilities.

3) How to detect phishing and malware threats

Common phishing techniques you should know

Phishing involves tricking individuals into providing sensitive information. Here are some common phishing techniques that you need to be aware of to stay ahead in the cat-and-mouse game that is the modern cybersecurity threat landscape.

Email Phishing: What should you look for?

Be cautious of emails that:

- Urgently request personal information.
- Come from unfamiliar or suspicious email addresses.
- Contain grammatical errors or unusual language.
- Include unexpected attachments or links.

Social media and messaging app scams

Scammers may use social media or messaging apps to impersonate friends or organisations. Be wary of unsolicited messages requesting money, personal data, or clicking on links.

Links and attachments: Beware of clicking!

Avoid clicking on links or downloading attachments from unknown sources. Hover over links to preview the URL and verify its legitimacy before clicking.

Types of Malware and their impact

Understanding malware types helps in prevention of cyber threats. You need to know various ways cyberthreats may enter your secure digital space.

Trojans, Spyware, and Adware explained

- **Trojans:** Malicious software disguised as legitimate programs that give attackers access to your system.
- **Spyware:** Software that secretly records your activities and sends the information to attackers.
- **Adware:** Unwanted software that displays ads and can redirect your browser to unsafe sites.

How to recognise signs of malware infection

Signs include:

- Slow device performance.
- Frequent crashes or freezes.
- Unexpected pop-up ads.
- New toolbars or icons you didn't install.
- Unusual network activity.

How to prevent phishing and malware attacks

Avoiding suspicious links and attachments

- Do not click on links or download attachments from unknown senders.
- Verify the authenticity of the sender if the message seems out of character.

Inculcating safe browsing habits

- Use reputable browsers with built-in security features.
- Keep your browser and plugins updated.
- Avoid visiting suspicious websites or downloading content from untrusted sources.